

Of Bots That Crawl News Sites, People Who Get Knighted, And Robots That Replace Wives

1 eBay founder Pierre Omidyar and his wife, Pamela, contributed \$1 million to the well-heeled campaign supporting Proposition 71, which would make available \$3 billion for a research undertaking in California. What is it?



- a. RFID for endangered species
- b. Stem cell research
- c. A new generation chip
- d. AIDS

2 Name the Indian company whose *HamaraCD.com* service lets users create personalised audio CDs of their favourite songs from a database of over 25,000 songs in 12 languages.

- a. T Series
- b. Sony Music India
- c. Times Music
- d. Sa Re Ga Ma

3 Which software giant recently launched a 'Newsbot' that will crawl news headlines from more than 4,800 other sites, in an effort to counter Google's automated news service?

- a. AOL
- b. Yahoo!
- c. Microsoft
- d. Sun Microsystems

4 Which non-IT Indian company recently made a foray into the IT sector by signing an agreement with business software solutions provider, SAP India, for marketing and distribution of SAP solutions for the metals and mining industry in the country?

- a. HLL
- b. Maruti Udyog
- c. Tata Steel
- d. JK Group

5 Michael Herf and Lars Perkins founded Picasa Inc in 2001, which develops software that enables users to manage and share digital photos. Recently, Picasa was acquired by a California-based IT major to enhance its blogging service by adding picture sharing. Which biggie are we talking about here?

- a. Hotmail
- b. Google
- c. Yahoo!
- d. Rediff

7 On July 12, 2004, a new world computer chess champion was crowned in Israel after it defeated the defending software program, Shredder. This program places less emphasis on the value of individual pieces and more on factors such as mobility and positional advantage, which gives the program the ability to find unusual and daring moves. What is the program called?

- a. Junior
- b. Deep Blue Jr
- c. Demolisher
- d. Starter

8 Recently, he was granted the rank of Knight Commander, Order of the British Empire in recognition of his "services to the global development of the Internet." The person in question is...

- a. Bill Gates
- b. Pierre Omidyar
- c. Jeff Bezos
- d. Tim Berners-Lee

6 Name the playwright whose 1972 novel, in which a group of men swap their wives for lookalike robots, inspired the Hollywood flick *The Stepford Wives*, starring Nicole Kidman.

- a. Arthur Miller
- b. Tennessee Williams
- c. Ira Levin
- d. Eugene O'Neill



Got an interesting question? Send it in with the answer to editor@thinkdig.it.com

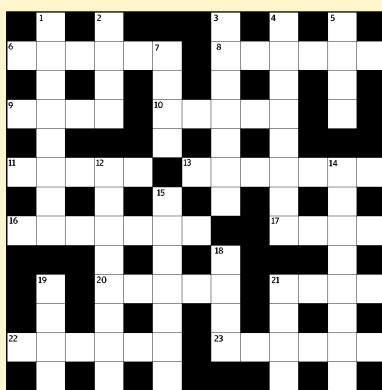
Crossword

Across

- 6. Entrap is confused by this main programme (6)
- 8. A Redwood Shores, California Company (6)
- 9. Solid, magnetic disk to store computer data (4)
- 10. Action taken by a programme when unable to run (5)
- 11. Radio Detection and Ranging (abbr) (5)
- 13. Graphical process of changing object size (7)
- 16. Intel Corp's trade name for it's family of Pentium II's (7)
- 17. Location on the World Wide Web rearranges ties (4)
- 20. Clock or switch deformsmier (5)
- 21. A CRT terminal in a conduit (4)
- 22. Move up, down, sideways through a document (6)
- 23. Opposite of Digital (6)

Down

- 1 Electronic filing system rearranges a bad seat (8)
- 2 Computer geek (4)
- 3 A modem will ----- a computer to a phone line (7)
- 4 Method of computation in a special notation (8)
- 5 Search system is at the Lord's table endlessly (4)
- 7 Telephony Application Programming Interface (abbr) (4)
- 12 Message window (5,3)
- 14 Portable, self-contained computer (8)
- 15 Prescription for an equation (7)
- 18 Storage section in a domain (4)



- 19 Tool to write programme code? (4)
- 21 Group of workers upset mate (4)

Compiled by Nitaa Jaggi

Steve Jobs received a private jet plane as a bonus in January 2000 for his performance as interim CEO of Apple Computer.

Did you know?

Answers

- 1: b, 2: d, 3: c, 4: c, 5: b, 6: c, 7: a, 8: a.
Quiz
Hack, 21. Team
14. Notebook, 15. Formula, 18. Area, 19.
4. Calculus, 5. Alta, 7. Tapl, 12. Alert box,
Down 1. Database, 2. Nerd, 3. Connect,
23. Analog
17. Site, 20. Timer, 21. Tube, 22. Scroll,
Panic, 11. Radar, 13. Scaling, 16. Celeron,
Across 6. Parent, 8. Oracle, 9. Hard, 10.
Crossword